

6.8 Pre-Boarding Notifications

A Pre-Boarding Notification (PBN) is a 'virtual envelope' where the details of the Master Reference Numbers (MRN's) of all the customs declarations relating to the goods are held together in one place. Each PBN has a unique identifier called the PBN ID.

A PBN may be required in order for commercial vehicles to board a ferry that travels between Ireland and Great Britain. Detailed instructions on [how to create or request a PBN](#) are available on the Revenue website.

6.9 Oral declarations

In specific cases, a customs declaration may be lodged using means other than electronic data-processing techniques.

One example is orally or by means of an act replacing a customs declaration. Travellers are notably entitled to lodge an oral declaration (as far as their personal luggage and means of transport are concerned) as well as private consignees (in respect of certain small consignments).

An oral declaration for the release of goods into free circulation may be lodged in certain circumstances.

In practice the two main uses of oral declarations are for goods of a non-commercial nature and also goods of a commercial nature contained in a traveller's personal baggage and not exceeding either €1,000 in value or 1,000kg in weight (Article 135 DA). Further information on the [procedure for temporary admission of goods using an oral declaration](#) is available on the Revenue website.

An oral declaration cannot be made for goods which are subject to prohibitions or restriction (Article 142 DA).

Where goods that are subject to import duty or other charges have been declared orally, Revenue are to issue a receipt to the declarant against payment of the amount due (Article 217 IA).

The receipt should include the following information:

- Description of the goods sufficient to enable the goods to be identified.
- Invoice value or, where it is not available, the quantity of the goods.
- Amount of the charges collected.
- Date on which the receipt is issued.
- Name of the issuing Customs office.